

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Brawn to Be Wild

TIGER SHROFF, 31

Actor

"I have seen Tiger put the highest level of focus, dedication, discipline and passion towards his craft and always striving to better it. I see growth in him not over time but every single day"

SAJID NADIADWALA
Producer

There are a handful of bankable leading men in Hindi cinema, but few have carved a niche as a bona fide action star as Tiger Shroff has. Shroff is in a league of his own when it comes to pulling off awe-inspiring stunt sequences. There's not just great athleticism on display but also a balletic beauty to his movements. With his training in martial arts, Shroff has single-handedly elevated the benchmark for action in Indian cinema which for long relied on brawny heroes to screech in rage and punch at will to brandish machismo.

Through his oeuvre which has mostly seen him play the role of a one-man army (*War* being an exception), Shroff has garnered a fan following that's distributed evenly between single screens and multiplex-going audiences. It's why he's currently one of the few actors to have two franchises in *Heropanti* and *Baaghi*. 2022 will be a pivotal year for Shroff who is positioning himself as an heir to the throne of the ageing Khans as his films (*Heropanti 2* and *Ganapath*) arrive on the sought-after release dates of Eid and Christmas. What Shroff lacks in thespian credentials to his peers, he makes it up with his physical prowess and terpsichorean skills. And at the box office that combination pays rich dividends. ■

–Suhani Singh

LYRICAL BENT Tiger also has a musical side to him. He has released three singles– 'Unbelievable' and 'Casanova' in English and 'Vande Mataram'.